Transparency report

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At Pinterest, our mission is to bring everyone the inspiration to create a life they love, and it's our guiding light in drafting and enforcing our content policies.

Not everything on the internet is inspiring, so we have guardrails for what's acceptable on Pinterest and what isn't allowed. Our moderation practices are always evolving to keep up with new behaviors and trends and to create a more positive corner of the internet for the people on our platform. We continue to invest heavily in measures like machine learning technology to fight policy-violating content on Pinterest and to work with outside experts and organizations to inform our policies and content moderation practices.

We started publishing a biannual transparency report in 2013, and expanded it starting with Q4 2020 to include more information on the actions we take to uphold our Community guidelines. In this transparency report, you'll find information on our efforts to moderate user and merchant content, such as the number of policy violations and deactivations. It also includes insight into the volume of information and deactivation requests we received from law enforcement and government agencies. This report, which encompasses more than 400 individual data points, covers the first half of 2022, from January through June 2022.

Pinterest's industry-leading policies and practices are something we're proud of. But more importantly, they're the right thing for the people on our platform. They help to keep Pinterest a more positive and inspiring place online—for example, we prioritize mental health with features like our compassionate search function, and help protect users under our longstanding policy prohibiting medical misinformation. We want to advance the industry on these issues so that—together—we can create a more inspiring internet.

What's new in this report

We've continued to expand our reporting to provide greater insight into our efforts, and in this transparency report, we've added a new section on Climate Misinformation.

Our new policy makes Pinterest the first major digital platform to have clearly defined guidelines against false or misleading climate change information, including conspiracy theories, across content and ads.

As part of our Community guidelines on misinformation and disinformation, our climate misinformation policy actions content that may harm the public's well-being, safety or trust, including:

- Content that denies the existence or impacts of climate change, the human influence on climate change, or that climate change is backed by scientific consensus.
- False or misleading content about climate change solutions that contradict well-established scientific consensus.
- Content that misrepresents scientific data, including by omission or cherry-picking, in order to erode trust in climate science and experts.
- Harmful, false or misleading content about public safety emergencies, including natural disasters and extreme weather events.

Tackling issues like climate change or misinformation is complex, and requires the support and collaboration of an entire ecosystem. We have partnered with experts including the Climate Disinformation Coalition and the Conscious Advertising Network to help inform and develop our policy based on common misinformation themes they're seeing across media platforms.

We're committed to providing greater transparency into how we keep Pinterest safe and inspiring, and we'll continue to iterate on this report going forward.

Community safety and wellbeing

We continue to invest in our policies, products and partnerships to support the safety and wellbeing of our community. Here are just some of the key updates we made in the first half of 2022.

Expanding compassionate search

Pinterest is a leader in building product experiences with emotional wellbeing in mind. People turn to Pinterest to find encouragement and alleviate stress or anxiety and they're discovering wellbeing techniques that work. That's why we created compassionate search, which offers a collection of interactive activities to help Pinners safely access supportive resources to improve their mood if they are feeling stressed, anxious, sad or trying to manage difficult emotions. This year, we expanded the feature to 11 countries for a total reach of 23 countries.

Expanding hair pattern in EU, LATAM

Earlier this year, Pinterest announced the international expansion of hair pattern search in France, Spain, Italy, Germany, Austria, Brazil, Mexico, Argentina and Colombia. Hair pattern search provides a more nourishing and inspiring experience for Pinners by enabling them to refine hair searches by six different hair patterns: protective, coily, curly, wavy, straight and shaved/bald. Hair pattern responds to the millions of Pinners around the world who are looking for an easier way to find the hair inspiration they are already searching for on Pinterest.

Pinterest's support for Ukraine

As the situation in Ukraine unfolded, we prioritized humanitarian aid for people affected and worked to keep our platform safe from disinformation.

Pinterest donated USD $250,000 to the International Rescue Committee and launched a special donation Pin to provide a trusted way for Pinners to be inspired to donate directly to the organization.

We also established a Ukraine Humanitarian Support Fund with multiple organizations for employees to contribute and matched all employee donations.

Shining a light on our transgender Pinners

For International Transgender Day of Visibility, we highlighted trans creators through new channels like Pinterest TV, explored how people were using Pinterest to dig into trans topics and provided support to trans-led and -focused organizations. Internally, we celebrated our trans Pinployees, Pinners and Creators within Pinterest through a week of community programming, guest speakers and other activities.

Celebrating Trans Day of Visibility is part of Pinterest's ongoing commitment to building an inspired culture and making Pinterest a safe place where everyone can create a life they love.

Community guidelines enforcement

Pinterest's Community guidelines are designed to support our mission of inspiration. They govern what we do and don't allow on Pinterest, and all users must abide by them.

We have additional guidelines for merchants and advertisers to set clear expectations about what is and is not acceptable for product Pins and advertisements. These guidelines include especially high standards that are for the safety of all audiences who use Pinterest. We believe you can't feel inspired if you don't first feel safe.

To help us cultivate a safe and inspired community, we develop and enforce content policies that help ensure our platform is a positive place where people can find real-life ideas for what to try next, cook next, wear next or do next. We work hard to identify and deactivate harmful content from our site, and our content policies and moderation practices are always evolving to keep up with new behaviors and trends and to create a more positive corner of the internet for everyone.

We may block, limit the distribution of or deactivate content and the accounts, individuals and groups that create or spread that content, based on how much harm it poses. In the event that a user believes a deactivation was in error, Pinterest provides options to appeal the deactivation.

Methodology

Distinct images and Pins deactivated

Every day, millions of people all over the world come to Pinterest to create, discover and save new ideas that are shared in Pins. To understand how we approach content moderation, it's helpful to differentiate between two types of Pins: organic Pins and ads. Our Community guidelines apply to both.

Organic Pins include all Pins created and saved on Pinterest that are not promoted as ads. For example, this could include merchants' product Pins, which aren't always ads, and may appear organically to people who are searching for products on Pinterest. We have additional requirements for merchants and their product Pins, such as that the Pin image and description must accurately represent the product. All types of organic Pins are included in our transparency reports.

Ads are Pins that businesses pay to promote. We have additional policies for advertisers that hold ads and advertisers to even higher standards. Ad policies are enforced differently than organic content, and are not included in our transparency reports.

Much of the content on Pinterest has been saved repeatedly, meaning that the same image may appear in multiple Pins. So when it comes to reporting actions we take on organic Pins under our policies, we include the number of Pins deactivated as well as the number of distinct images deactivated to provide greater insight into our moderation practices for this type of content.

We report boards and accounts deactivated separately. To avoid double-counting deactivations, our count of distinct images and Pins deactivated does not include those on boards or from user accounts that were deactivated.

How we deactivate Pins

We deactivate policy-violating Pins through automated tools, manual review and a hybrid approach that combines elements of both.

Automated deactivations. Our automated tools use a combination of signals to identify and take action against potentially violating content. Our machine learning models assign scores to each image added to our platform. Using those scores, our automated tools can then apply the same enforcement decision to other Pins containing the same images.

Manual deactivations. We manually deactivate Pins through our human review process. Pins deactivated through this process may include those identified internally and those reported to us by third parties. It also includes the Pins that are reviewed and deactivated by one of our team members after a user report.

Hybrid deactivations. Hybrid deactivations include those where a human determines that a Pin violates policy, and automated systems help expand that decision to enforce against machine-identified matching Pins. Depending on the prevalence of matching Pins, a hybrid deactivation may result in a number of Pins deactivated or none at all.

The mechanisms used to address different potential policy violations may vary based on the state of available technology, the volume of violative content and other factors such as the complexity of evaluation. We continue to iterate and evolve our tools and expect ongoing improvements going forward.

Deactivations for a policy category may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Reach of Pins deactivated for violating policy

People often ask, how many users saw a Pin before it was deactivated? In most cases, the answer is: not a lot.

For example, 91% of Pins that we deactivated for medical misinformation in Q2 were never seen by users in that reporting period—even with more than 400 million people visiting Pinterest per month.

Reach is one of our key indicators of user experience. To calculate this metric, we start by looking at each policy-violating Pin deactivated in a reporting period. Then we count the number of unique users that saw each of those Pins during the reporting period for at least 1 second before it was deactivated.

In this report, we've updated the labels we use to report this metric, but the underlying methodology has remained the same:

- **Seen by 0 people** means that no one saw that Pin in the reporting period
- **Seen by 1-9 people** means a Pin was seen by at least 1 and no more than 9 people in the reporting period
- **Seen by 10-100 people** means a Pin was seen by at least 10 and up to 100 people in the reporting period
- **Seen by >100 people** means a Pin was seen by more than 100 people in the reporting period

Reach for a policy category may not add up to 100% due to rounding.

Actioned user reports

Users can report Pins they think violate our policies by clicking on the three small dots on any Pin and hitting "Report Pin." Once we confirm that an item violates our Community guidelines and take appropriate action, we consider the report an actioned user report.

The total number of actioned user reports is another key indicator of user experience on Pinterest. So is the number of reporters: fewer than 0.01% of monthly active users reported a Pin that resulted in a Pin deactivation in Q2.

Boards deactivated

When users find Pins they like or want to come back to, they save them to boards that they've created. Over time, our users have created billions of boards.

When a board is deactivated for violating policy, all the Pins on that board are also deactivated. Similarly, when we deactivate an entire account, that user's boards are also deactivated. To avoid double-counting deactivations, our count of boards deactivated does not include those from user accounts that were deactivated.

Accounts deactivated

Think of "accounts" on Pinterest as "profiles" or, most often, individual users. If someone saves Pins and creates boards, that content becomes associated with their account. This is also true for business, advertiser, merchant and creator accounts.

Any account may be deactivated for violating our policies. When an account is deactivated, all of its Pins and boards are also deactivated. That means that if you search for them or click on an old link to their profile, that profile won't show up anymore. Their Pins won't appear anywhere on Pinterest. And the deactivated user won't be able to access their own Pins or boards, either.

Account appeals and reinstatements

If people believe their accounts have been deactivated by mistake, they can appeal to try to have their accounts reinstated. We review appeal requests and grant the appeal if we determine we made a mistake, or in some cases to give people another chance to abide by our Community guidelines.

We also process appeals for deactivated Pins and boards and expect to include that data in reports in the future.

Reporting periods

Our reporting on Community guidelines enforcement covers the first half of 2022, from January to June 2022. We've split that time into two reporting periods: Q1 and Q2.

Q1 covers the first quarter of the year, from January through March, while Q2 covers the second quarter of the year, from April through June. Sometimes we also refer to Q3 (July to September) or Q4 (October to December) when we're talking about quarter-over-quarter trends.

Adult content

Pinterest isn't a place for pornography. We take action against content that violates our adult content policy and do not deliver results for searches determined to violate this policy. We have established guidelines to help differentiate between pornography and other mature content such as content related to sexual health, breastfeeding, mastectomies, art and education.

Recent trends

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q1 and Q2, 99% were seen by 100 or fewer users in that reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach* of Pins deactivated for adult content

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	78%	77%
Seen by 1-9 people	18%	19%
Seen by 10-100 people	3%	3%
Seen by >100 people	1%	1%

** See our methodology section above for details on how we calculate reach.*

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **975,774** distinct images, which comprised **22,309,237** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **78%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **61,599** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **47,965** boards and **7,699** accounts. We received **2,104** account appeals and reinstated **1,229** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **1,058,729** distinct images, which comprised **27,606,227** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **77%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **69,077** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **43,757** boards and **6,571** accounts for violating this policy. We received **1,674** account appeals and reinstated **1,070** accounts.

Adult sexual services

We prohibit adult sexual services on Pinterest. Adult sexual services may involve sexual exploitation or commercial sex work, such as escort services, sex cams, or sex- or nudity-for-money services.

Recent trends

We deactivated more Pins for violating our adult sexual services policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. This was the result of a hybrid deactivation of a small handful of images, which account for almost two-thirds of Pins deactivated in Q1 for violating this policy.

Of the Pins we deactivated in Q1 and Q2, at least 99% were seen by 100 or fewer users in that reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for adult sexual services

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	95%	82%
Seen by 1-9 people	5%	14%
Seen by 10-100 people	0.5%	3%
Seen by >100 people	0.1%	0.9%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **6,052** distinct images, which comprised **208,296** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **95%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **158** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **129** boards and **117** accounts. We received **9** account appeals and reinstated **3** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **21,746** distinct images, which comprised **51,936** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **82%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **201** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **146** boards and **156** accounts for violating this policy. We received **4** account appeals and reinstated **1** account.

Child sexual exploitation (CSE)

Pinterest does not tolerate child sexual exploitation (CSE) of any kind on our platform. That means we enforce a strict, zero-tolerance policy for any content—including imagery, video, or text—that might exploit or endanger minors. Detecting and removing this type of content is of the utmost importance to our Trust and Safety team, and we are proud of our broad-reaching policies and robust efforts to keep our users safe.

Pinterest's CSE policy prohibits not just illegal child sexual abuse material (CSAM), but goes a step further to prohibit any content that contributes to the sexualization of minors. For example, we do not tolerate content that suggests the sexualization of minors in the form of cartoons or anime. We also prohibit the intentional misuse of content depicting minors engaging in non-sexualized activities, like modeling clothing or participating in athletics.

We proactively identify CSE images and videos by leveraging our own internal tools and shared industry tools such as PhotoDNA, which uses a shared industry hash database of known CSAM, and CSAI Match to identify video content. We also work closely with the National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) to combat this type of activity, and report content violations as required under the law. From January to June 2022, our team of specialists was responsible for 4,969 CyberTipline reports to NCMEC.

A note on what we're reporting and why

CSE is one of the most serious harms addressed by Trust and Safety teams at Pinterest and across the internet. Because of this sensitivity, it deserves extra consideration as we decide how to present information in this report. After consulting with industry experts, Pinterest ultimately chose to include all of the same metrics for CSE that we include for our other content policies, including reach and actioned user reports. These types of metrics are our indicators for how policy-violating content impacts the experience of users on the site. However, we want to be very clear: By sharing reach and actioned user reports for CSE content, we are not implying in any way that harm to children is somehow lessened if fewer people see it. The content is violative and wrong, no matter how many people see it. We share the data only to be transparent in our efforts to remove CSE from our platform.

We also count all deactivations for CSE, no matter what other actions may have already been taken against the Pin, board or user. For example, if a Pin has been automatically deactivated—meaning no one on the platform can see it—for violating our Spam policy but we later learn that it contains material that violates our CSE policy, the Pin is counted in both our Spam and CSE deactivation numbers. Even though that Pin had not been visible or accessible on Pinterest, we still need to take appropriate action, like making a report to National Center for Missing and Exploited Children (NCMEC) if we determine that the image is illegal CSAM. We've included those deactivations in our reporting on CSE to provide more accurate insight into these violations.

While we work hard to find and remove this type of content, there is always more work to do—and we are committed to doing it.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for child sexual exploitation (CSE)

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	63%	61%
Seen by 1-9 people	28%	30%
Seen by 10-100 people	6%	6%
Seen by >100 people	3%	2%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **2,499** distinct images, which comprised **300,003** Pins, for violating our CSE policy. Of these, we determined that **184** distinct images, which comprised **542** Pins, were illegal CSAM, and we reported them to NCMEC. Of the total Pins deactivated this quarter for CSE, **97%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **1,735** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **492** boards and **10,743** accounts. We received **2,164** account appeals and reinstated **1,169** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we saw an increase in Pin deactivations due to an update in our detection systems. We deactivated **9,085** distinct images, which comprised **712,295** Pins, for violating our CSE policy. Of these, we determined that **2,038** distinct images, which comprised **4,988** Pins, were illegal CSAM, and we reported them to NCMEC. Of the total Pins deactivated this quarter for CSE, **98%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **1%** manually and **99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **2,399** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **1,162** boards and **37,694** accounts for violating this policy. We received **7,467** account appeals and reinstated **5,971** accounts.

Civic misinformation

Our civic misinformation policy is one of several policies in our Community guidelines that prohibit misinformation and disinformation on Pinterest. This policy prohibits false or misleading content on Pinterest that impedes an election's integrity or an individual's or group's civic participation, including registering to vote, voting and being counted in a census.

Recent trends

Fighting misinformation is complex and always evolving. Content enforcement numbers may change quarter-to-quarter depending on real-world events, such as the French presidential election in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, 97% were seen by 100 or fewer users in that reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for civic misinformation

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	20%	46%
Seen by 1-9 people	67%	47%
Seen by 10-100 people	5%	5%
Seen by >100 people	8%	3%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **712** distinct images, which comprised **840** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **92%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **90%** of Pins manually and **10%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **339** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **42** boards and **10** accounts. We received **4** account appeals and reinstated **1** account.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **1,541** distinct images, which comprised **2,782** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **97%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **69%** of Pins manually and **31%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **315** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **33** boards and **9** accounts for violating this policy. We received **4** account appeals and reinstated **2** accounts.

Climate misinformation

In April 2022, Pinterest launched a new climate misinformation policy to keep false and misleading claims around climate change off the platform. As part of our Community guidelines that prohibit misinformation and disinformation, our climate misinformation policy removes content that may harm the public's well-being, safety or trust, including things like content that denies the existence or impacts of climate change and false or misleading content about natural disasters and extreme weather events.

Our climate misinformation policy is yet another step in Pinterest's journey to combat misinformation and create a safe space online. This policy makes Pinterest the first major digital platform to have clearly defined guidelines against false or misleading climate change information, including conspiracy theories, across content and ads.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for climate misinformation

	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	13%
Seen by 1-9 people	81%
Seen by 10-100 people	4%
Seen by >100 people	2%

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **1,120** distinct images, which comprised **1,218** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **13%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **99%** manually and **fewer than 1%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **968** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **132** boards and **7** accounts for violating this policy. We received **0** account appeals and reinstated **0** accounts.

Conspiracy theories

Our conspiracy theories policy is one of several policies in our Community guidelines that prohibit misinformation and disinformation on Pinterest. Conspiracy theories include content that turns or encourages turning individuals, groups of people, places or organizations into targets of harassment or physical violence, such as hate-based conspiracy theories and misinformation about mass atrocities.

Recent trends

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, 99% were seen by 100 or fewer users in that reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for conspiracy

Reach of Pins deactivated for conspiracy theories

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	57%	84%
Seen by 1-9 people	33%	14%
Seen by 10-100 people	5%	1%
Seen by >100 people	5%	1%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **2,579** distinct images, which comprised **5,039 Pins**, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **57%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **67%** of Pins manually and **33%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **556** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **223** boards and **19** accounts. We received **6** account appeals and reinstated **4** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **3,857** distinct images, which comprised **14,312** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **84%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **77%** manually and **23%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **506** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **311** boards and **19** accounts for violating this policy. We received **37** account appeals and reinstated **8** accounts.

Dangerous goods and activities

Pinterest isn't a place for trading or selling dangerous goods or engaging in dangerous activities. Dangerous goods are products or substances that might cause harm when used, altered or manufactured irresponsibly. Dangerous activities—including displaying or encouraging dangerous activities—are also not welcome on Pinterest.

Recent trends

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, 98% were seen by 100 or fewer users in that reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for dangerous goods and activities

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	72%	64%
Seen by 1-9 people	21%	31%
Seen by 10-100 people	4%	3%
Seen by >100 people	3%	2%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **11,308** distinct images, which comprised **55,985** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **72%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **16%** manually, **12%** automatically and **72%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **1,525** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **603** boards and **222** accounts. We received **12** account appeals and reinstated **2** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **12,253** distinct images, which comprised **81,286** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **98%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **12%** of Pins manually, **7%** automatically and **81%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **2,328** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **583** boards and **245** accounts for violating this policy. We received **11** account appeals and reinstated **3** accounts.

Graphic violence and threats

We prohibit graphic violence and threats on Pinterest. This includes most content that shows the use of violence, threats and language that glorifies violence.

Recent trends

In Q1 2022, we saw a large increase in Pins deactivated compared to Q4 2021, in part because of the content related to the war in Ukraine. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q1 2022, 97% were seen by 100 or fewer users in that reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for graphic violence and threats

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	65%	67%
Seen by 1-9 people	29%	28%
Seen by 10-100 people	4%	2%
Seen by >100 people	3%	4%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **9,662** distinct images, which comprised **124,008** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **97%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **9%** of Pins manually and **91%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **2,440** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **800** boards and **120** accounts. We received **25** account appeals and reinstated **9** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **12,845** distinct images, which comprised **96,854** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **96%** were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period. We deactivated **27%** of Pins manually and **73%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **3,346** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **633** boards and **60** accounts for violating this policy. We received **25** account appeals and reinstated **14** accounts.

Harassment and criticism

Pinterest is not a place for harassment and criticism, and we prohibit content that insults, hurts or antagonizes individuals or groups of people. This includes manipulated images intended to degrade or shame, shaming people for their bodies or assumed sexual or romantic history, sexual remarks about people's bodies, solicitations or offers of sexual acts, and mocking someone for experiencing sadness, grief, loss or outrage.

Recent trends

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, 98% were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for harassment and criticism

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	74%	58%
Seen by 1-9 people	21%	35%
Seen by 10-100 people	3%	4%
Seen by >100 people	3%	2%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **3,128** distinct images, which comprised **61,237** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **74%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **5%** of Pins manually and **95%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **3,506** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **931** boards and **197** accounts. We received **28** account appeals and reinstated **16** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **9,672** distinct images, which comprised **232,858** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **58%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **4%** of Pins manually and **96%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **6,446** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **1,356** boards and **266** accounts for violating this policy. We received **55** account appeals and reinstated **38** accounts.

Hateful activities

We prohibit hateful content and the people and groups that promote hateful activities on Pinterest. Hateful activities include slurs and negative stereotypes, caricatures and generalizations, as well as support for hate groups and people promoting hateful activities.

Recent trends

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, 92% were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period.

Reach of Pins deactivated for hateful activities

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	63%	62%
Seen by 1-9 people	22%	26%
Seen by 10-100 people	6%	4%
Seen by >100 people	9%	8%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **4,016** distinct images, which comprised **27,585** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **63%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **16%** of Pins manually and **84%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **2,004** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **726** boards and **105** accounts. We received **31** account appeals and reinstated **6** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **5,774** distinct images, which comprised **40,455** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **62%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **15%** of Pins manually and **85%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **3,603** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **705** boards and **76** accounts for violating this policy. We received **33** account appeals and reinstated **12** accounts.

Medical misinformation

Our medical misinformation policy is one of several policies in our Community guidelines that prohibit misinformation and disinformation on Pinterest. This policy prohibits medically unsupported health claims that risk a user's health or wider public health and safety, including the promotion of false cures, anti-vaccination advice, or misinformation about public health or safety emergencies. We rely on information from nationally and internationally recognized institutions, including the Centers for Disease Control and World Health Organization, to help us determine if content violates these guidelines.

Recent trends

Pinterest is deeply committed to combating health misinformation. We continue to engage with public health experts to stay on top of trends and get feedback on our policy and enforcement approaches for topics such as medical misinformation.

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, more than 99% were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for medical misinformation

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	85%	91%
Seen by 1-9 people	13%	8%
Seen by 10-100 people	0.7%	0.3%
Seen by >100 people	1%	0.4%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **4,426** distinct images, which comprised **113,195** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **85%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **4%** of Pins automatically, **3%** manually and **93%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **651** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **513** boards and **17** accounts. We received **4** account appeals and reinstated **1** account.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **3,906** distinct images, which comprised **262,909** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **91%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **2%** of Pins automatically, **2%** manually and **97%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **573** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **299** boards and **4** accounts for violating this policy. We received **1** account appeal and reinstated **1** account.

Self-injury and harmful behavior

Combating self-harm is a priority for us as we strive to ensure Pinterest plays a positive role in people's lives. Content that displays, rationalizes or encourages suicide, self-injury, eating disorders or substance abuse isn't welcome on our platform. This includes self-harm instructions, sensitive imagery, and suicidal thinking and quotes. We also block search terms related to self-harm. Currently our blocking list includes more than 25,000 terms.

Our ongoing partnership with Samaritans, an organization dedicated to reducing feelings of isolation and disconnection that can lead to suicide, continues to help the industry tackle self-harm content and make the internet a safer place for everyone. Partnerships like this help us support expert research and development within the field of mental health so that more people in need can find support, no matter what app or website they use.

Recent trends

We continued investing in work to improve content moderation for self-harm content. As a result, we saw a large increase in Pins deactivated in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, 99% were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period.

We provided support millions of times to those in need by expanding compassionate search to 11 additional countries, a feature that offers a collection of interactive activities to help Pinners safely access supportive resources to improve their mood if they are feeling stressed, anxious, sad or trying to manage difficult emotions.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for self-injury and harmful behavior

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	71%	93%
Seen by 1-9 people	23%	6%
Seen by 10-100 people	3%	0.6%
Seen by >100 people	3%	0.4%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **6,574** distinct images, which comprised **107,059** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **71%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **6%** of Pins manually and **94%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **1,917** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **16,144** boards and **61** accounts. We received **30** account appeals and reinstated **9** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **8,494** distinct images, which comprised **1,232,828** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **93%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** of Pins manually and **99%** with hybrid tools. We actioned **2,270** user reports that resulted in a Pin deactivated for violating this policy. We also deactivated **14,667** boards and **29** accounts for violating this policy. We received **21** account appeals and reinstated **10** accounts.

Spam

We want the inspiration and ideas on Pinterest to be high-quality and useful, so we deactivate spam when we find it. The goal of spammers is to make money, and the best way to do this is to spam at scale. It's a numbers game: one million spam emails are much more effective than one spam email. The same kinds of spamming efforts can happen on any content distribution platform, including Pinterest. Platforms' interactions with spammers are generally both adversarial and iterative with users who intentionally try to evade the system and continually update their techniques.

Recent trends

At Pinterest, we use the latest in machine learning technology to build automated models that swiftly detect and act against spam of all kinds. We not only use the latest modeling techniques but also iterate on these models at regular intervals by adding new data and exploring new technical breakthroughs to either maintain or improve their performance over time to effectively address spam. Given the adversarial, iterative nature of fighting spam, content enforcement numbers may change quarter-to-quarter, especially after a large attack.

We deactivated fewer Pins for violating this policy in Q1 2022 than in Q2 2022. Of the Pins we deactivated in Q2, more than 99% were seen by 100 or fewer users in this reporting period.

Content enforcement

Reach of Pins deactivated for spam

	Q1 2022	Q2 2022
Seen by 0 people	60%	89%
Seen by 1-9 people	34%	10%
Seen by 10-100 people	4%	0.8%
Seen by >100 people	1%	0.3%

In Q1 2022, we deactivated **35,243** distinct images, which comprised **74,941** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **60%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** of Pins manually and **more than 99%** automatically. We also deactivated **0** boards and **1,477,695** accounts for violating this policy. We received **98,156** account appeals and reinstated **79,469** accounts.

In Q2 2022, we deactivated **37,398** distinct images, which comprised **259,996** Pins, for violating this policy. Of these Pins, **89%** were never seen by users in this reporting period. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** of Pins manually and **more than 99%** automatically. We also deactivated **10,543** boards and **1,680,646** accounts for violating this policy. We received **73,639** account appeals and reinstated **55,930** accounts.

Intellectual property policies enforcement

Pinterest respects the intellectual property rights of others and we expect people on Pinterest to do the same. It's our policy in appropriate circumstances to deactivate the accounts of people who repeatedly infringe or are repeatedly charged with infringing copyrights or other intellectual property rights.

Intellectual property notices

Pinterest provides multiple mechanisms to submit notices alleging intellectual property infringement. The first can be found in-product right next to the content at issue. Rights holders or their authorized representatives can report Pins they believe infringe their intellectual property rights by clicking on the three small dots on any Pin and hitting "Report Pin," where they will find a link to report for IP infringement. We also provide standalone, publicly-available reporting forms and dedicated email addresses, as well as our physical address, for submitting intellectual property notices, all of which can be easily located on our Policy site.

Rights holders have the option to identify one piece of content or many. We assess each piece of content identified in a submission and when we determine a report is complete and valid, we will promptly process the report and action the content as appropriate. If we need more information about the reporting party or about any content identified, we engage with the person or entity that submitted that notice to give them the opportunity to provide that information. If at any point they are able to submit a complete and valid notice alleging intellectual property infringement, Pinterest will process the notice and deactivate the content identified.

We may consider a notice to be invalid and decline to deactivate content identified when appropriate, such as when the notice:

- Does not include all legally required information
- Does not make a plausible intellectual property claim, as when a use is non-infringing
- Is not actionable, including when the content has already been deactivated
- Is spam

Given the complex nature of intellectual property cases, we've included a number of metrics to provide greater insight into the steps that we take to assess intellectual property submissions and engage with the people or entities who submit them.

Appeals

When a user's content is deactivated as the result of an intellectual property notice, we send them an email notification that includes information on how to appeal our actions if they wish to do so. We evaluate appeals, which may be in the form of a counter-notice under the US Digital Millennium Copyright Act (DMCA), and remedy the situation if we determine that there was an actionable appeal. As we do with intellectual property notices, we engage with the person or entity who submitted the appeal to get more information if necessary. If at any point they are able to submit a complete and valid appeal, Pinterest will take appropriate action to remedy the situation.

Copyright

Pinterest has always been a place for content creators, brands and publishers worldwide to feature their content and build value. Many creators upload their own content or encourage users to do so using buttons on their websites designed to facilitate saving to Pinterest, and welcome the exposure and user traffic generated when users save images. We work hard to give creators control over their content, including by designating which websites should be linked to and receive traffic from saved images, using features like our "No Pin" code if they wish to restrict saving from their websites, or claiming content on Pinterest through our Content Claiming Portal.

In cases where rights holders do not want their content to appear on Pinterest, we offer several mechanisms for content removal. Copyright owners and those authorized to act on their behalf can report alleged copyright infringements through our copyright reporting mechanisms including our in-product reporting option, our reporting form or via email to copyright@pinterest.com. Once we've assessed a copyright notice, we take appropriate action, which may include removing the reported content from Pinterest. We also offer the Content Claiming Portal, a tool launched in 2021 that enables rights holders to claim their content and decide if and how it appears on Pinterest. When we take action based on a copyright notice or information gathered in the Content Claiming Portal, we notify affected users and provide information on how to appeal our actions if they wish to.

Copyright and other forms of intellectual property present unique content moderation challenges. While moderators can often identify content that violates our other policies, like those prohibiting adult content or threats, simply by looking at the content, this is not the case for copyright. Identifying copyright infringement generally requires additional knowledge about the content's origin, legal status, ownership, licensing or other information that is not readily apparent—such as whether the owner authorized use by another party through agreements that Pinterest is not privy to. Because of this, rightsholders alone are in a position to know whether a particular use is or is not authorized. The notification process is a means for rights holders to provide this necessary information to Pinterest. Copyright is also unique because the proper response to infringement is not always to deactivate the content. Some rights holders may choose to deactivate content, while others prefer to keep their content on Pinterest but correct its attribution or add a link to their website.

For these reasons, both our moderation process and the data reported here are not always directly comparable to our other sections on Community guidelines enforcement. That's why, for example, we've added metrics such as the number of notices we processed based on the initial submission and the number of times we sought more information, and omitted our metric showing the reach of deactivated Pins. We've updated our methodology for calculating the number of copyright notices that require additional information before processing. As a result, the respective data in previous published reports are not directly comparable to those in the first half of 2022. We're committed to providing greater transparency into how we enforce intellectual property protections on Pinterest, and we'll continue to iterate on this report going forward.

Content enforcement

In Q1 2022, we received **22,975** submissions through our copyright reporting mechanisms. Of these submissions, **191** were determined to be requests unrelated to intellectual property and forwarded to the appropriate team at Pinterest. We determined that another **1,953** were spam and discarded them. We found **12,585** to be complete upon submission, and we processed all content identified in each notice. We sought information for an additional **7,438** submissions which we determined to be incomplete and ultimately processed **1,652** of those submissions. In total, we processed **14,237** notices and deactivated **63,817** distinct images, which comprised **13,995,413** Pins, under our copyright policies. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** of Pins manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We deactivated **380** accounts for violating our policy against repeat infringers. We received **650** appeals, found **487** to be complete and facially valid, and took appropriate action.

We also received **5,211** requests through the Content Claiming Portal in Q1 2022. We processed **3,443** requests, which included deactivating **112,211** distinct images, comprising **2,703,791** Pins. We received **235** appeals for content deactivated in this manner, found **120** to be complete and facially valid, and took appropriate action.

In Q2 2022, we received **22,438** submissions through our copyright reporting mechanisms. Of these submissions, **248** were determined to be requests unrelated to intellectual property and forwarded to the appropriate team at Pinterest. We determined that another **1,709** were spam and discarded them. We found **13,038** to be complete upon submission, and we processed all content identified in each notice. We sought information for an additional **5,839** submissions which we determined to be incomplete and ultimately processed **1,493** of those submissions. In total, we processed **14,531** notices and deactivated **41,667** distinct images, which comprised **12,898,085** Pins, under our copyright policies. We deactivated **fewer than 1%** of Pins manually and **more than 99%** with hybrid tools. We deactivated **381** accounts for violating our policy against repeat infringers. We received **799** appeals, found **616** to be complete and facially valid, and took appropriate action.

We also received **20,792** requests through the Content Claiming Portal in Q2 2022. We processed **19,152** requests, which included deactivating **34,407** distinct images, comprising **1,245,013** Pins. We received **106** appeals for content deactivated in this manner, found **45** to be complete and facially valid, and took appropriate action.

Trademark

Pinterest respects the trademark rights of others. Trademark owners can contact us through our trademark reporting mechanisms, such as our in-product reporting option, the trademark complaint form or by emailing us at trademark@pinterest.com, if they have concerns that content on Pinterest infringes their trademark rights. We review submissions we receive and take appropriate action, including removal of the content at issue from Pinterest.

As with copyright, both our moderation process and the data reported here are not always directly comparable to our other Community guidelines enforcement. That's why, for example, we've added metrics such as the number of notices we processed based on the initial submission and the number of times we sought more information, and omitted our metric showing the reach of deactivated Pins. We've updated our methodology for calculating the number of trademark notices that require additional information before processing. As a result, the respective data in previous published reports are not directly comparable to those in the first half of 2022.

Content enforcement

In Q1 2022, we received **4,078** submissions through our trademark reporting mechanisms. Of these submissions, we determined that **364** were spam and discarded them. We found **990** to be complete upon submission, and we processed all content identified in each notice. We sought information for an additional **2,497** submissions which we determined to be incomplete and ultimately processed **97** of those submissions. In total, we processed **1,087** notices and deactivated **27,859** distinct images, which comprised **36,215** Pins, under our trademark policies. We deactivated **100%** of Pins manually. We deactivated **241** boards and **205** accounts under our trademark and related policies. We received **5** appeals, found **0** to be complete and facially valid, and accordingly did not reinstate any content in response.

In Q2 2022, we received **3,321** submissions through our trademark reporting mechanisms. Of these submissions, we determined that **367** were spam and discarded them. We found **905** to be complete upon submission, and we processed all content identified in each notice. We sought information for an additional **1,778** submissions which we determined to be incomplete and ultimately processed **72** of those submissions. In total, we processed **977** notices and deactivated **27,125** distinct images, which comprised **34,366** Pins, under our trademark and related policies. We deactivated **100%** of Pins manually. We deactivated **164** boards and **241** accounts under our trademark and related policies. We received **4** appeals, found **0** to be complete and facially valid, and accordingly did not reinstate any content in response.

Law enforcement and government agency requests

This section provides insight into the volume of information and deactivation requests received from law enforcement and government agencies in the first half of 2022, from January through June 2022. For more information on how we respond to requests for account information, refer to our Law enforcement guidelines.

Government information requests

Pinterest receives legal requests from law enforcement and government agencies for Pinterest account information. We diligently review each request, and only produce data for those that meet the requirements of law and our policies. Our policy is to notify users of government requests for their information prior to disclosing, except in narrow circumstances, such as where we are prohibited by law.

United States

Types	Requests	Some information produced	Accounts identified	Accounts notified**
Subpoena	42	27	98	4
Court Order	4	2	5	0
Warrant	19	17	19	4
Other*	2	2	3	0
Total	**67**	**48**	**125**	**8**

** Law enforcement requests such as wiretap orders, pen registers, trap and trace, and emergency disclosure requests.*

*** The account owner was notified before production.*

International

Country	Types	Requests	Some information produced	Accounts identified	Accounts notified**
Brazil	Other*	1	0	0	0
Canada	Other*	1	1	1	0
Finland	Other*	1	0	0	0
France	Other*	3	2	2	0
Germany	Other*	3	2	2	0
India	Other*	13	0	0	0
Poland	Other*	1	0	0	0
Spain	Other*	4	0	0	0
United Kingdom	Other*	3	1	1	0
Total		30	6	6	0

** Law enforcement requests such as emergency disclosure requests and requests issued pursuant to local law.*

*** The account owner was notified before production.*

National security requests*

Time period	No. of requests
January through June 2022	0-249

** Any national security letters and orders issued under the US Foreign Intelligence Surveillance Act for user information.*

Government content deactivation requests

We sometimes receive requests from government agents to deactivate content on Pinterest that may be illegal in their country and/or a violation of our Community guidelines.

We review the requests to determine if the content identified violates our Community guidelines. Our teams take action on violations, ranging from deactivating the content globally to restricting access to the content within the relevant country if it violates local law but does not violate our policies.

Pinterest received requests to take down 8,857 pieces of content from January to June 2022. We deactivated content for 7,894 of those requests for violating our Community guidelines and restricted content on 637 requests. Content for 326 requests was inactive by the time it was reviewed in response to the government removal request. This can happen when, for instance, the content was deactivated in response to a user report prior to Pinterest receiving the government removal request.

Country	Requests	Community guidelines deactivations*	Local law deactivation**	Inactive***
Belgium	1	1	0	0
Canada	1	1	0	0
France	2	2	0	0
India	7	4	1	2
Indonesia	8	1	7	0
South Korea	8,102	7,299	524	279
Russia	703	570	87	43
Turkey	32	12	18	2
Total	8,856	7,890	637	326

** Content violated our Community guidelines and was removed from the platform.*

*** Content was reported by a government agency but did not violate our Community guidelines and was restricted from appearing only in the country where the request originated, based on local law.*

**** Content was no longer available on the platform by the time it was reviewed in response to the government removal request.*

Building toward a safer internet

Creating the most positive space online doesn’t happen by accident: It happens through proactive policy and product decisions. We have industry-leading positions on content safety that are informed by inputs and advice from outside experts, civil society and government. We also invest heavily in measures like machine learning technology to maintain a safe and positive space for the people on Pinterest. We’re proud of what we’re doing to keep Pinterest safe and to move the broader industry forward.

Let’s create a safer, more inspired internet, together.

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